

Microsoft Word itself to make your Web page; Dreamweaver (www.macromedia.com) is a far better software for making HTML pages, though. These don't require any knowledge of HTML and you simply type the text, put in the images and the software writes the HTML for you. Once you have all your pages, you can upload them to your Web site and you're done. All free Web hosting services allow you to upload files from a friendly Web-based interface, so you can upload files just as you would select attachments for e-mail.

How can I receive e-mail from Web-based services in Outlook Express?

It is possible to receive Hotmail messages in Outlook Express. To set up the Hotmail account, click **Tools > Accounts** in Outlook Express and click **Add > Mail**. Follow the wizard and enter your Hotmail address when asked



Outlook Express automatically configures Hotmail accounts

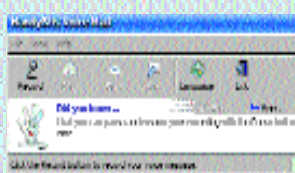
for the e-mail address. Outlook Express will automatically set up the account and synchronise the folders.

Apart from this, you cannot receive Web-based e-mail on a mail client. If the mail service supports POP or IMAP access, only

then can you configure it to your mail software. Free services such as Fastmail.fm (www.fastmail.fm), SubDimension.com (www.subdimension.com), and MyRealBox (www.myrealbox.com), among others, that allow you to use the service using Outlook or Outlook Express, over POP or IMAP. You can get the details of the SMTP and POP3 servers from each site. In your mail client, when configuring the account, choose the appropriate protocol (POP3 or IMAP) and enter the SMTP server address for the Outgoing mail server and the POP server address for the Incoming mail server. Earlier, Yahoo! used to allow POP access to e-mail, but now it is a paid service. If you subscribe with them for POP access, you can receive Yahoo! mail over Outlook or Outlook Express, too.

How can I send voice messages by e-mail?

Sending voice messages by e-mail is fairly simple. All you need is a soundcard and a microphone. You have to record your message to a WAV or MP3 file using a sound recording software and attach it to your e-mail. Make sure that the file doesn't get very large though. To reduce file size, you can reduce the quality at which it is recorded. Using the MP3 format also ensures small files. Also, record in single-channel (mono) mode using 8-bit samples at 11 KHz if the software allows you to choose the settings. These settings are adequate for voice. The recipient can play



Send voice messages using HandyBits Voice Mail

the sound file directly from the mail client or download the attachment from a Web-based e-mail service.

You can also use free software such as HandyBits Voice Mail (<http://download.com.com/3000-2369-6606638.html?tag=lst-0-7>) for this. All you need to do is record and send. It offers high compression of voice messages, though it records sound to WAV files, allowing your messages to be played on almost any computer.

I've heard that most viruses today spread via e-mail. How do I ensure that my PC is safe?

There are some ways to identify and avoid infection due to viruses that are spread by e-mail. Usually, such viruses are attached to the message itself. On double-clicking the attachment, the virus activates and infects the PC. From then onwards, it starts running off your system. Though most such viruses do little harm, they send themselves out to others in your address book, sometimes with large attachments. Thus, you should avoid opening attachments from your e-mail, especially if you are not sure who sent it to you and for what purpose. Since these viruses spread through the address book,

you cannot trust the sender's address. If it seems important, check with the sender whether it was intentionally sent to you.

Some viruses that spread by e-mail may use JavaScript within the message to either run malicious code or open a Web page that can run malicious script. To avoid encountering such e-mail, turn off message previewing in your mail client—if you don't view (open) it, the script cannot execute. Delete mail with suspicious sender addresses and subject lines without viewing them.



AVG scans your hard disk and monitors your e-mail for viruses

Avoiding viruses is not the final solution. Virus developers keep learning new tricks every day, so you should install a good anti-virus software on your system and have it running at all times. AVG (www.grisoft.com) is a good free anti-virus package that can keep a tab on not only your hard disk, but your e-mail too.

How do I make the most of my dial-up connection?

Dial-up connections end up costing a bomb if you add the cost of the ISP and, more significantly, the telephone bills, especially if you have to keep redialling. If you use



THE ESSENTIAL HAND BOOK
HARD DISK DRIVES brought to you by **digit** AND **SAMSUNG**
a New Technology Corporation the No. 1 PC Assembly Company